בְּכָל דּוֹר וָדוֹר

IN EVERY *GENERATION*

~9 min
NARRATED · ENGLISH

12
SCENES · 10 GENERATIONS

SCENE 01

A night sky · 1899

Opening — the question

0:00–0:55

126 W

GUIDE

> “If the statistics are right, the Jews constitute but one per cent of the human race. It suggests a nebulous dim puff of star-dust lost in the blaze of the Milky Way. Properly the Jew ought hardly to be heard of.”
>
> “The Egyptian, the Babylonian, and the Persian rose, filled the planet with sound and splendor, then faded to dream-stuff and passed away; the Greek and the Roman followed, and made a vast noise, and they are gone. The Jew saw them all. All things are mortal but the Jew. What is the secret of his immortality?”
>
> Mark Twain wrote that in 1899.
>
> He had no idea what was coming.
>
> In every generation, they rise up against us.
>
> This film is the answer to his question.

VISUAL

Black, then the Milky Way, slowly. As the guide names them, constellations go out one by one and each is, for a moment, an empire: a pyramid, a ziggurat, a Persian lion, a Greek column, a Roman eagle — each dissolving to dust. At “What is the secret” the sky is empty. Black. A single flame lights: a candle in a window, seen from the street.

EMOTION

Curiosity, then vertigo. The date lands like a blade.

REFERENCES

Mark Twain, “Concerning the Jews”, Harper's Magazine, September 1899 — public domain, quoted with cuts (see notebook). The flame in the window is the Hanukkah image that returns in Scene 3 and the closing.

SCENE 02

Egypt · c. 1300 BCE

Shifra, Puah, Moses

0:55–1:35

73 W

GUIDE

It began with a crown. A new Pharaoh looked at the Hebrews and said: they are too many — let us deal shrewdly with them. Bricks. Then the Nile, for every boy born. The order went to two midwives, Shifra and Puah. They did not carry it out, and lied to the king's face. One of the boys they spared, Moses, came back forty years later with four words: Let my people go.

VISUAL

Mud-brick works at dawn, a line of bent backs. A scribe reads a decree; the Nile, wide and slow. Two women, Shifra and Puah, before a throne — one lifts her chin and lies. A basket among reeds. Cut forty years: a man with a staff and a stammer stands in the same throne room and says four words. No plagues, no sea on screen: the hands, the basket, the staff.

EMOTION

The first "no" in history, spoken by two midwives.

REFERENCES

Exodus 1:9–10 (Pharaoh's line), 1:15–21 (the midwives), 5:1. The Haggadah's first-person telling: Pesachim 116b.

SCENE 03

Shushan, Persia · c. 470 BCE

Esther

1:35–2:15

98 W

GUIDE

In Persia, the hatred learned to write. A minister named Haman drafted the decree — a people scattered among the nations, whose laws are different; not worth tolerating — and sealed it with the king's ring: every Jew in the empire, on a single day. The queen, Esther, was a Jew, and no one at court knew. To enter the throne room unsummoned was death. She fasted three days, and walked in. If I perish, I perish. Haman hanged on the gallows he had built. And to this day, every spring, children drown out his name with noise.

VISUAL

A palace of glazed brick. A hand presses a signet ring into wax; couriers ride out in every direction. A woman alone in a corridor, robes on, a long doorway ahead; the sceptre lowered, then raised. Hard cut to tonight: a synagogue on Purim, a reader reaches a name, a hundred noisemakers, a child grinning.

EMOTION

A woman walking toward a door that means death — and the sound of children, twenty-four centuries later.

REFERENCES

Esther 3:8–13 (the decree, condensed), 4:11–16 (thirty days; "if I perish"), 7:10 (the gallows). 127 provinces: 1:1.

SCENE 04

Modi'in, Judea · 167 BCE

Mattathias and Judah Maccabee

2:15–3:08

118 W

GUIDE

For the Greeks the problem was simpler: the Jews were the people who would not join in — would not eat with the others, would not bow to the city's gods. King Antiochus called himself Epiphanes — "God made manifest" — and outlawed the Sabbath, the Torah and circumcision on pain of death. In Modi'in, an old priest, Mattathias, was ordered to bow to an altar in the village square. He tore it down, and walked into the hills with his five sons. The third, Judah, earned a nickname: Maccabee. The Hammer. Farmers against war elephants. Three years later, to the day, Judah lit the lamp in Jerusalem. We still light it in the window, facing the street.

VISUAL

A hill village, an altar of new stone in the square, a Seleucid officer in bronze. An old man's hands on the altar; it goes over. Five figures climbing into olive terraces at dusk. Night in a mountain pass — torches, the dark bulk of an elephant that cannot turn. Then a lamp lit in a vast dark hall; match-cut to a hanukkiah in a São Paulo window, and the street beyond it lighting up.

EMOTION

Nerve. Farmers who choose the night and the hills.

REFERENCES

1 Maccabees 1–4; 2 Maccabees 6 (the decrees, the altar). Rededication 25 Kislev 164 BCE, "three years to the day" (1 Macc 4:52–54). Pirsumei nisa — lighting toward the street: Shabbat 21b.

SCENE 05

Barcelona · 1263

Nachmanides

3:08–3:53

99 W

GUIDE

In the Middle Ages the hatred acquired a theology — the Jews had killed God — and from it came the blood libel, the poisoned wells, the yellow badge, the expulsions. In Barcelona, King James of Aragon ordered the greatest rabbi in Spain, Nachmanides, to debate the Church before the court, and granted him one thing: freedom to speak. He spoke for four days. The king said he had never heard an unjust cause so nobly defended. And exiled him. Nachmanides went to Jerusalem, found two Jews living in the ruins, and built a synagogue. It is open tonight.

VISUAL

A Gothic hall, the king on a raised chair, friars on one side, one old man standing alone on the other, a single candle on his lectern. Four dawns through the same window. A purse of coins placed in his hand; the same hand, later, holding a sealed order of exile. A ship's rail; Jerusalem in ruins; two men dyeing cloth in a courtyard; a wall rising. Last shot: the Ramban synagogue tonight, a lamp inside.

EMOTION

Dignity under a rigged game — and the quiet revenge of building.

REFERENCES

Disputation of Barcelona, 20–27 July 1263, before James I of Aragon, against the convert friar Pablo Christiani; Nachmanides' own Hebrew account (Vikuach) gives the 300 solidi and the king's remark; the Latin protocol disagrees on the outcome. Exile 1265; Jerusalem 1267, letter to his son ("two brothers, dyers"). The Ramban Synagogue in the Jewish Quarter, restored 1967.

SCENE 06

Lisbon → Istanbul · 1536–1556

Gracia Nasi

3:53–4:38

81 W

GUIDE

Then the hatred stopped asking what a Jew believed, and began asking what he was born. In Lisbon, a widow of twenty-six, Gracia Nasi, banker to kings and secretly a Jew, turned her ships into a road out: Antwerp, Venice, Ferrara, Istanbul. Thousands passed along it. When the Pope burned twenty-four conversos alive at Ancona, in 1556, she closed the port to every Jewish merchant in the Ottoman Empire. No one had ever done that before. One woman, against the Pope.

VISUAL

A genealogy on an Inquisition desk, names traced for "blood". A young widow in black at a ledger; her seal in wax; a map with a thread Lisbon–Antwerp–Venice–Ferrara–Istanbul, lanterns moving along it at night. Ancona: an edict nailed to a door, smoke over the harbour. Istanbul: she dictates, and in the port dozens of ships turn away from Ancona's quay.

EMOTION

Cold intelligence used as mercy. The first time money said no.

REFERENCES

Limpieza de sangre statutes from Toledo 1449. Gracia (Beatriz de Luna, 1510–1569); the papal debt and the Ferrara–Istanbul route per Cecil Roth. Ancona 1556: 24 (some say 25) burned; the boycott was real and unprecedented but collapsed within about a year — the narration claims the act, not the victory.

SCENE 07

Paris · 1895

Alfred Dreyfus and Theodor Herzl

4:38–5:18

92 W

GUIDE

In the nineteenth century the hatred put on a lab coat: science had discovered that the Jew was a race. In Paris, the most modern army in Europe forged a note, and Captain Alfred Dreyfus, the only Jew on the General Staff, was stripped of his rank before twenty thousand people screaming Death to the Jews. He shouted back: I am innocent. In the crowd, a reporter from Vienna, Theodor Herzl, heard the scream, went home, and wrote eighty pages: The Jewish State. Fifty years later, the eighty pages were a country.

VISUAL

Archival engraving of the degradation; reconstruction: braid torn from a uniform, a sabre snapped over a knee, the roar beyond the railings. Dreyfus's mouth, shouting. In the crowd, a bearded man with a notebook, not writing. A desk in Vienna, a title page: Der Judenstaat. Archival: Tel Aviv, 14 May 1948, Ben-Gurion under Herzl's portrait.

EMOTION

Humiliation turned, in one man's head, into a plan.

REFERENCES

Degradation 5 January 1895; contemporary estimates of 4,000 troops inside and ~20,000 outside. Marr's Antisemitismus (1879) is the "lab coat". Exoneration 1906. Der Judenstaat, February 1896 (c. 80 pages in the first edition). Independence 14 May 1948.

SCENE 08

Kishinev → Galilee · 1903–1909

The Shomrim

5:18–5:58

86 W

GUIDE

In Russia, the Tsar's police forged a book — The Protocols of the Elders of Zion — which said the Jews ruled the world, and let the mob loose in Kishinev. Forty-nine dead in two days, with the police watching. This time the Jews did not wait. They bought revolvers. And in 1909, on a hill in the Galilee, ten young men saddled horses and founded the first Jewish guard in nineteen centuries: HaShomer. The Watchman. The Watchman became the Haganah. The Haganah became an army.

VISUAL

A printing press; a title page in Cyrillic. Archival photographs of Kishinev after the pogrom — broken windows, feathers in the street, policemen with folded arms; no bodies. A cellar, young men checking revolvers. Then light: a ridge in the Galilee at dusk, ten riders, kaffiyehs, a rifle across a saddle. Match-cut: a patrol jeep's headlights on the same ridge tonight.

EMOTION

The moment the Jews stop waiting.

REFERENCES

Kishinev, Easter 1903: 49 dead. Protocols first serialised in Znamya, Aug–Sep 1903; Okhrana authorship is the standard attribution. Gomel, September 1903: first organised self-defence. HaShomer founded April 1909 (Bar-Giora 1907); Haganah 1920; IDF 1948.

SCENE 09

Warsaw · Sobibor · the forests · 1943

Anielewicz, Pechersky, the Bielski brothers

5:58–6:48

100 W

GUIDE

And then the hatred bought a railway.

(silence — image only)

In Warsaw, Mordechai Anielewicz, twenty-three, with five hundred fighters and pistols, held the ghetto for a month against an army. At Sobibor, Alexander Pechersky led the prisoners who killed their guards and ran for the trees. In the forests of Belarus, three brothers — Tuvia, Asael and Zus Bielski — took in everyone: the old, the sick, the children. Twelve hundred walked out alive. Seventeen years later, the man who ran the trains sat in a glass box in Jerusalem, and a hundred and eleven survivors told the world.

VISUAL

A railway timetable, destinations in Fraktur. Then silence and image only, ten seconds: rails, a signal, snow. Warsaw: Stroop Report photographs chosen for defiance — fighters, smoke over the wall; never the famous boy. A calendar: three days crossed out, then a month. Sobibor: a clock at four; a workshop door; three hundred people running for a treeline, in silence; pines planted over bare ground. Naliboki: dugouts, a kitchen, a school, a column walking out in July light. Archival: the glass booth in Jerusalem; a witness's face.

EMOTION

The quietest scene in the film. No commentary; the facts do the work.

REFERENCES

Warsaw: 19 April – 16 May 1943; Stroop's three-day plan; Anielewicz's last letter, 23 April. Sobibor, 14 October 1943: eleven SS killed (some say twelve), ~300 escaped, 50–60 survived; camp razed and planted. Bielski: ~1,200 at liberation, July 1944. Eichmann: 111 witnesses, 1961.

SCENE 10

Entebbe · Moscow · Addis Ababa · 1976–1991

Yoni Netanyahu, Natan Sharansky, the Fourteen Thousand

6:48–7:33

102 W

GUIDE

After the war the old word became unsayable. The hatred found another: Zionist. At Entebbe, Uganda, the hijackers separated the Jews from the other passengers. Ninety minutes after the first Israeli plane landed in the dark, the hostages were in the air; the commander, Yoni Netanyahu, did not come home. In Moscow, Natan Sharansky, jailed for wanting to leave, told the court: Next year in Jerusalem. Nine years in the Gulag — and he kept it. From Ethiopia, in 1991, fourteen thousand Jews were lifted out in thirty-six hours, on planes with the seats torn out. Babies were born in the air.

VISUAL

A terminal at night; a hijacker reading passports, one group moved aside. A Hercules landing without lights; a black Mercedes rolling off the ramp; bare feet running up a ramp. Archival: Ben Gurion, 4 July 1976. A Soviet courtroom; a small man with a wide grin. Archival: the Glienicke Bridge, a figure zigzagging across the line. Archival: a 747 with no seats, people on the floor, an old man kissing the tarmac.

EMOTION

Three different kinds of courage: the soldier, the prisoner, the pilot.

REFERENCES

Entebbe: 27 June – 4 July 1976; 102 of 106 hostages rescued; Yoni Netanyahu the only soldier killed. Sharansky tried July 1978; freed 11 February 1986 (the zigzag is his own account). Operation Solomon, 24–25 May 1991: 14,325 people, 35 flights; the 1,088-passenger 747 holds the Guinness record.

SCENE 11

Nir Am · Tel Aviv · everywhere · 2023

Inbal Rabin-Lieberman and Noa Argamani

7:33–8:18

85 W

GUIDE

Until one Shabbat morning, on Simchat Torah. And a week later, on every screen, every costume at once — the blood, the plot, the new word. At Nir Am, Inbal Rabin-Lieberman, twenty-five, opened the armory before the army arrived, and the kibbutz lost no one. Three hundred thousand came home on any plane that would take them. Eight months later, Noa Argamani came out of Gaza alive, into her father's arms. And where the posters were torn down, someone put them back up. Every morning.

VISUAL

6:29 a.m., a siren, the Negev sky at dawn — nothing more. A steel door, keys, a rack of rifles, twelve men taking positions along a fence; no enemy shown. Archival: Ben Gurion arrivals, duffel bags, strangers hugging. Archival: a synagogue with police outside; a hand tearing a poster from a lamp post. Archival: Noa Argamani stepping off a helicopter into her father's arms. The lamp post again, dawn: a hand taping a new poster over the scraps.

EMOTION

Mourning and stubbornness. People, not operations.

REFERENCES

Nir Am: zero casualties; Rabin-Lieberman's role widely reported (avoid "the only kibbutz"). Reservists c. 300,000 (IDF). Noa Argamani rescued 8 June 2024. Incident surges: ADL, CST, CRIF. No footage of October 7 itself. Verify hostage status before production.

SCENE 12

Online · today

The ones fighting now

8:18–8:43

8 W

GUIDE

> And now, it looks like this. Not generals.

VISUAL

A phone screen, vertical. Fifteen to twenty seconds of real clips, cut fast, names on screen: a singer walking through Auschwitz; an actress holding a thin book; an Arab Israeli filming from the north; an Emirati speaking Arabic, subtitled; a non-Jewish musician on a stage in Israel. No narration over their voices.

EMOTION

Lightness after weight. The answer is alive and ordinary.

REFERENCES

See production notes for the shortlist and the verification rule.

SCENE 13

The sky again

Closing — the answer

8:43–9:03

31 W

GUIDE

Twain asked what the secret was.

There is no secret. There are names.

In every generation, they rise up against us —

and in every generation, someone rises.

Am Yisrael Chai.

VISUAL

The night sky of the opening. But now each star that lights is a face: Shifra, Esther, Judah, Nachmanides, Gracia, Dreyfus, Herzl, the Watchman, Anielewicz, Pechersky, the Bielskis, Yoni, Sharansky, Inbal, Noa — the sky filling back up. Below them, a street at Friday dusk, windows lighting one after another. Final card over the stars.

EMOTION

Fullness. The question answered.

REFERENCES

Vehi She'amda, sung in full. Final card: IN EVERY GENERATION · בכל דור ודור · SMV emblem · sixmillionvoices.org.

IN EVERY GENERATION

בְּכָל דּוֹר וָדוֹר

Twain asked what the secret was. There is no secret. There are names.